

STEP

1. Passage anchor

> “Because of her, I became more willing to **step outside my comfort zone**...”

Passage meaning

****step outside**** = move beyond a familiar or safe boundary, literally or figuratively

****踏出；走出；跨出****

Here, ****step outside my comfort zone**** is metaphorical:

= do something unfamiliar, challenging, or slightly uncomfortable in order to grow

****走出舒適圈；跨出熟悉安全的範圍****

Practice

1. Joining the debate club helped me ****step outside my comfort zone****.

加入辯論社幫助我****走出舒適圈****。

2. Sometimes growth begins when you are willing to ****take a step beyond what feels familiar****.

有時候，成長就從你願意****跨出熟悉範圍一步****開始。

Core meanings of STEP

2. step — one movement made by lifting and putting down a foot

= a single movement of the foot while walking

****一步；步伐****

Examples

1. She took a ****step**** forward.

她向前****走了一步****。

2. He heard ****steps**** behind him.

他聽見身後有****腳步聲****。

This is the central physical noun meaning.

3. take a step

= make one movement with the foot

****走一步；跨一步****

Examples

1. Take one ****step**** back.

往後退****一步****。

2. She took a ****step**** toward the door.

她朝門口****走了一步****。

4. step forward / backward / aside

= move one or more steps in a particular direction

****向前 / 向後 / 往旁邊走****

Examples

1. Please ****step forward****.

請****往前一步****。

2. He ****stepped aside**** to let her pass.

他****往旁邊讓開****，讓她經過。

Verb: move by taking a step

5. step somewhere

= move by placing one foot somewhere

****踏；踩；走****

Examples

1. She ****stepped into the room**** quietly.

她安靜地****走進房間****。

2. He ****stepped onto the platform****.

他****踏上月台****。

6. step on something

= put your foot on something

踩到；踩在……上

Examples

1. Be careful not to **step on the glass**.
小心不要**踩到玻璃**。

2. I accidentally **stepped on his foot**.
我不小心**踩到他的腳**。

7. step in / into

A. physically enter

走進；踏入

1. She **stepped into the lift**.
她**走進電梯**。

B. become involved in a situation

介入；出面

2. The manager **stepped in** to resolve the dispute.
經理**出面介入**解決爭議。

This figurative sense is very common.

8. step out / outside

A. physically leave or go outdoors

走出去；到外面

1. I **stepped outside** for some fresh air.
我**走到外面**呼吸新鮮空氣。

B. figuratively move beyond a boundary

****跨出；走出****

2. She was ready to ****step outside her comfort zone****.
她準備好****走出舒適圈****。

This is the passage use.

Distance

9. a step away

= a very short distance away

****一步之遙；很近****

Examples

1. The hotel is only a few ****steps away**** from the station.
飯店距離車站只有幾****步之遙****。

2. She was standing just a ****step away****.
她就站在****一步之外****。

10. within walking distance / a few steps from

Though not a distinct sense of ****step****, it frequently appears in location phrases:

* a few steps from the door

* ten steps away

****離.....幾步遠****

Progress and stages

11. step — a stage in a process

= one of a series of actions or stages used to achieve something

****步驟；階段****

Examples

1. The first **step** is to identify the problem.

第一步是找出問題。

2. Follow these three **steps** carefully.

仔細按照這三個**步驟**進行。

This is a major figurative extension.

12. first / next / final step

= a particular stage in a sequence

第一步 / 下一步 / 最後一步

Examples

1. What is the **next step**?

下一步是什麼？

2. Signing the form is the **final step**.

簽署表格是**最後一步**。

13. take steps to do something

= take deliberate action to achieve or prevent something

採取措施；採取行動

Examples

1. The company has **taken steps to reduce costs**.

公司已**採取措施降低成本**。

2. We need to **take steps to prevent** the problem from happening again.

我們需要**採取措施防止**問題再次發生。

This is more formal than simply **do something**.

14. a step toward something

= an action that contributes to progress toward a goal

朝.....邁進的一步

Examples

1. This agreement is an important ****step toward peace****.
這項協議是****邁向和平的重要一步****。
2. Asking for help was her first ****step toward recovery****.
尋求幫助是她****邁向復原的第一步****。

15. a step forward

= progress or improvement

****進步；向前邁進****

Examples

1. The new policy is a ****step forward****.
新政策是一項****進步****。
2. This discovery represents a major ****step forward**** in research.
這項發現代表研究上的重大****進展****。

16. a step backward / back

= regression or movement away from progress

****退步；倒退的一步****

Examples

1. Cancelling the programme would be a ****step backward****.
取消這個計畫將是一次****倒退****。
2. The decision felt like a ****step back****.
這項決定讓人覺得像是****退了一步****。

Rank or degree

17. a step up

= an improvement or move to a higher level

****提升；升級；更上一層****

Examples

1. The new role is a ****step up**** for her career.
新職位是她職涯上的一次****提升****。
2. This model is a ****step up from**** the basic version.
這個型號比基本版****高一個等級****。

18. a step down

= a reduction in rank, quality, responsibility, or status
****降級；降低****

Examples

1. He saw the new position as a ****step down****.
他認為新職位算是****降級****。
2. The replacement model is a ****step down in quality****.
替代型號在品質上****低了一個等級****。

Stairs

19. step — one part of a staircase

= a flat surface on which you place your foot when going up or down stairs
****階梯；台階****

Examples

1. She sat on the bottom ****step****.
她坐在最下面的****階梯****上。
2. Be careful on the wet ****steps****.
小心濕滑的****台階****。

20. steps — stairs, especially a short outdoor flight

= a set of steps leading to an entrance or another level

****階梯；臺階****

Examples

1. He was waiting on the front ****steps****.

他在門前的****階梯****上等。

2. We climbed the stone ****steps****.

我們爬上石製****台階****。

Dance and movement pattern

21. step — a particular movement in dancing

= a particular movement or sequence of foot movements

****舞步****

Examples

1. I still don't know the basic dance ****steps****.

我還不會基本****舞步****。

2. She taught us a new ****step****.

她教了我們一個新的****舞步****。

22. step — manner or rhythm of walking

= a particular way, pace, or rhythm of walking

****步伐；步態****

Examples

1. He walked with a confident ****step****.

他以自信的****步伐****走路。

2. She quickened her ****step****.

她加快了****腳步****。

Sound of walking

23. step / footsteps

= the sound made by someone walking

****腳步聲****

Examples

1. I heard a ****step**** outside the door.

我聽到門外有****腳步聲****。

2. Their ****steps**** echoed in the hallway.

他們的****腳步聲****在走廊裡迴盪。

In modern everyday English, ****footstep(s)**** is often clearer.

Common phrasal uses

24. step in

= intervene or become involved to help or control a situation

****介入；出面****

Examples

1. A teacher ****stepped in**** before the argument became serious.

爭吵變嚴重之前，一名老師****出面制止****。

2. The government may need to ****step in****.

政府可能需要****介入****。

25. step down

= leave an important job or position

****下台；辭職；卸任****

Examples

1. The director decided to ****step down****.

主任決定****辭職 / 卸任****。

2. She ****stepped down as chair**** last year.

她去年**卸任主席**。

This is a high-value phrasal verb.

26. step up

A. increase effort, activity, or intensity

加強；提高

1. We need to **step up our efforts**.
我們需要**加大努力**。

B. accept greater responsibility

挺身而出；承擔更多責任

2. Someone needs to **step up and lead**.
必須有人**挺身而出帶領大家**。

27. step back

A. physically move backward

後退

1. Please **step back** from the edge.
請從邊緣**往後退**。

B. temporarily distance yourself in order to think objectively

退一步看；暫時抽離

2. We need to **step back and look at the bigger picture**.
我們需要**退一步看整體情況**。

28. step aside

A. move out of the way

****讓開****

1. Please ****step aside****.

請****讓開****。

B. leave a role or allow someone else to take over

****退位；讓位****

2. He agreed to ****step aside**** and let someone else lead.

他同意****讓位****，讓別人領導。

29. step out

A. leave briefly

****出去一下****

1. I need to ****step out**** for a few minutes.

我需要****出去一下****。

B. in some contexts, go out socially

****外出****

2. They decided to ****step out for dinner****.

他們決定****外出吃晚餐****。

High-value idioms

30. step by step

= gradually, one stage at a time

****一步一步地；逐步地****

Examples

1. We'll solve the problem ****step by step****.

我們會****一步一步地****解決這個問題。

2. Confidence develops ****step by step****.

自信是****逐步建立****起來的。

31. one step at a time

= deal with something gradually rather than all at once

****一步一步來****

Examples

1. Don't worry about everything at once—take it ****one step at a time****.

不要一次擔心所有事情，****一步一步來****。

2. Recovery happens ****one step at a time****.

復原需要****一步一步來****。

32. watch your step

A. be careful where you put your feet

****小心腳下****

B. figuratively, behave carefully

****小心行事****

Examples

1. ****Watch your step**** on the wet floor.

地板很濕，****小心腳下****。

2. You'd better ****watch your step**** around the new manager.

在新經理面前你最好****小心一點****。

33. mind your step

= be careful where you are walking

****小心腳下****

Examples

1. ****Mind your step**** as you get off the train.

下火車時**小心腳下**。

2. **Mind the step** at the entrance.

小心入口處的**台階**。

Especially common in British English.

34. keep in step

A. walk with the same rhythm as others

步調一致

B. figuratively keep pace with developments

跟上步伐

Examples

1. The soldiers marched **in step**.

士兵們**步伐一致**地行進。

2. Businesses need to **keep in step with technological change**.

企業需要**跟上科技變化的步伐**。

35. out of step

A. not walking in the same rhythm

步調不一致

B. not in agreement with current ideas, expectations, or developments

脫節；不合時宜

Examples

1. He was marching **out of step**.

他行進時**步伐不一致**。

2. The policy seems **out of step with modern needs**.

這項政策似乎與現代需求**脫節**。

36. follow in someone's footsteps

= do similar work or make similar life choices to another person

****追隨某人的腳步；走與某人相似的道路****

Examples

1. She ****followed in her mother's footsteps**** and became a teacher.

她****追隨母親的腳步****，成為了一名老師。

2. He did not want to ****follow in his father's footsteps****.

他不想****走父親走過的路****。

Lexically built from ****footstep****, but highly relevant to the semantic family.

37. get / be one step ahead

= be slightly more advanced, prepared, or informed than someone else

****領先一步****

Examples

1. She always tries to stay ****one step ahead****.

她總是設法****領先一步****。

2. Good planning keeps us ****one step ahead of problems****.

良好規劃讓我們能比問題****早一步應對****。

38. take a step back

= reconsider something from a greater distance or broader perspective

****退一步；重新審視****

Examples

1. Let's ****take a step back**** and reconsider the problem.

我們先****退一步****，重新思考這個問題。

2. Sometimes you need to ****take a step back**** before making a decision.

有時候做決定前需要先**退一步重新看清楚**。

Family forms and compounds

39. footsteps

= sounds or marks made by someone walking; figuratively, another person's path

腳步聲；足跡

Examples

1. I heard **footsteps** in the hallway.

我聽見走廊裡有**腳步聲**。

2. She followed in her mentor's **footsteps**.

她追隨導師的**足跡**。

40. doorstep

= the step or area immediately outside an entrance door

門階；家門口

Examples

1. The package was left on the **doorstep**.

包裹被放在**門口**。

2. Reporters gathered on his **doorstep**.

記者聚集在他的**家門口**。

41. stepchild / stepfather / stepmother

Here **step-** is a different historical element meaning a family relationship created through remarriage.

Examples:

* stepfather 繼父

* stepmother 繼母

* stepchild 繼子女

- * stepsister 繼姊妹
- * stepbrother 繼兄弟

This is **not** semantically derived from “one step” in modern English and should be learned as a separate combining form.

Key contrasts

42. step vs walk

step

= one individual movement of the foot, or a short deliberate movement

一步；踏

walk

= the overall activity of moving on foot

走路；步行

Compare:

> Take one **step** forward.

> 往前走**一步**。

> **Walk** to the door.

> **走到**門口。

43. step vs pace

step

= individual movement or stage

pace

= speed or rhythm of movement/progress

速度；步調

Compare:

> She took a **step** forward.

> 她向前走了一步。

> She walked at a fast **pace**.

> 她以很快的**步調**走路。

44. step vs stage

For processes:

****step****

= an action that forms part of a process

****步驟****

****stage****

= a period or phase within a developing process

****階段****

Compare:

> The next ****step**** is to send the form.

> 下一個****步驟****是寄出表格。

> The project is in its final ****stage****.

> 專案正處於最後****階段****。

45. step vs measure

In ****take steps to...****:

****step****

= action taken to achieve a goal

****measure****

= planned action, often formal or official

****措施****

Compare:

> We are ****taking steps**** to improve safety.

> 我們正在****採取行動****改善安全。

> The government introduced new safety ****measures****.

> 政府推出新的安全****措施****。

46. step outside vs leave

****leave****

= physically depart from a place

****離開****

****step outside****

can mean:

* literally go outside briefly

* figuratively cross beyond a familiar boundary

In the passage:

> ****step outside my comfort zone****

cannot naturally be replaced by literal ****leave my comfort zone**** without changing the metaphorical tone somewhat.

Meaning map

The central physical concept of ****step**** is:

****one movement of the foot****

From this develop several major branches:

Physical movement

take a step

→ ****走一步****

Stairs

a step

→ ****台階****

Progress

next step / step toward a goal

→ ****步驟；一步****

Improvement or decline

step up / step down

→ **提升 / 降低**

Intervention

step in

→ **介入**

Withdrawal

step back / step aside

→ **退一步 / 讓位**

Figurative boundaries

step outside your comfort zone

→ **跨出舒適圈**

The metaphor is highly productive:

physical movement forward or across a boundary

→ **psychological, professional, or developmental movement**

Passage recap

> “...I became more willing to **step outside my comfort zone**...”

Here:

step retains the image of taking a physical step, but it is used figuratively.

It means:

move beyond the limits of what feels familiar, safe, or comfortable

Best Traditional Chinese renderings:

* **走出舒適圈**

* **跨出自己的舒適範圍**

* **勇於嘗試不熟悉的事情**

MCQ-ready meaning

step in **“step outside my comfort zone”**

= **move beyond a boundary, figuratively by doing something unfamiliar or challenging**

跨出；走出

It does not simply mean “walk one physical step” here, although that literal movement supplies the metaphor.